

Gemini Smith she/her

Senior Backend Engineer • Go

Go • PostgreSQL • MongoDB • Data ingestion pipelines • Kubernetes • Istio • GCP • AWS • Root-cause debugging
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Senior backend engineer, 8+ years, mostly in Go. My strength is production systems that have started to hurt: I find the real cause and ship the fix that holds. Built failover protecting a \$430M revenue funnel, migrated 1.27B+ PostgreSQL rows with zero downtime, cut ingestion parsing jobs ~30%. Came up through test automation and DevOps, so I own the code, the pipeline, and the infrastructure under it. Self-taught.

EXPERIENCE

Gametime | Backend Software Engineer

Remote • 09/2023 – 09/2025

- **Built the Ticketmaster manifest ingestion subsystem solo** in ~5 months: ~1,600 lines of Go for normalization, two-tier validation, MLB event and venue matching, and delivery to Ticketmaster's API. Supported it live through the playoffs.
- **Cut parsing jobs ~30%** with a file-hash dedupe at the FTP ingress layer, ending ingest backlogs that let stale listings sell. Pitched it at a hackathon; it didn't place, and shipped to production weeks later anyway.
- **Repaired 22,684 orphaned listings** after tracing unsellable live inventory and refunds to listings in MongoDB with no PostgreSQL row. Added graceful shutdown to the CSV parser and extended the reconciliation tool to catch them.
- **Turned a class of hard listing rejections into matches** with a regex fallback matcher for supplier section and row data, plus per-listing match-method observability.
- **#1 or #2 contributor on several core services** (580+ commits across 15 repositories).

Syndio | Software Engineer (Backend)

Remote • 11/2021 – 05/2023

- **Owned permissions and RBAC** for a pay-equity platform serving Fortune 500 employers (PayEQ, \$19M ARR). Designed a YAML role model code-generated into Go and Python so the runtimes couldn't drift; shipped seat licensing as phased, backwards-compatible migrations.
- **Unblocked two teams with one piece of work.** Asked to stub an API for frontend, I built mock APIs with controllable responses plus a test suite that became the backend contract spec.
- **Ended a company-wide outage** in ephemeral environments that had every engineer and QA person hitting silent failures. Self-initiated; root-caused to NGINX response-header size limits. It never recurred.

Freshly | DevOps Engineer *(earlier Test Automation Engineer)*

Remote • 08/2019 – 11/2021

- **Protected a \$430M revenue funnel from third-party CMS outages** with an automated failover system I designed, scoped, and built in Go. It reroutes homepage traffic through Istio on failure and reverts on recovery; 88.9% core test coverage.
- **Migrated 1.27B+ PostgreSQL rows with zero downtime and zero post-migration fixes**, Heroku to GCP via Striim CDC. Built the tooling to split tables into 30 parallel import jobs under a hard 16-thread ceiling.
- **Traced a recurring production connection failure** to an hour-long silent hang in a third-party payment API inside a Postgres transaction; identified the fix (gRPC deadlines) and built the diagnostic path the team used afterward.
- Earlier, as Test Automation Engineer: built the Cypress and CircleCI test platform and led the CI migration off Semaphore.

Brightcove | Software Engineer (Backend) / Senior Software Engineer in Test

Scottsdale, AZ • 11/2016 – 08/2019

- **Rebuilt an ad server that is still running 6+ years after I left.** Unprompted, rebuilt a hardcoded, single-format ad server as configurable test infrastructure on AWS Lambda and DynamoDB: VAST, SmartXML/Freewheel, and Google DFP from one parameter-driven URL. Adopted company-wide, including sales demos.
- Backend Go engineer on the APIs behind the video ingest platform; sole test automation owner for Server Side Video and Ad Insertion, supporting 12+ Go engineers.

PROJECTS AND COMMUNITY

- **perfapi (Go):** API benchmarking harness. Wrote the Go service and orchestration CLI (deterministic port assignment, fleet lifecycle), then used AI coding tools to port the same API to 13 more languages.
- **Community:** Cucumber open source contributor (Ruby, Go); CircleCI guest author, two articles adopted into official docs; founded Ministry of Testing Phoenix; spoke at Phoenix Golang meetup and Desert Code Camp.

SKILLS

Languages: Go, Python, JavaScript, Ruby **Data:** PostgreSQL, MySQL, MongoDB, DynamoDB, Redis
Infrastructure: Kubernetes, Docker, Istio, NGINX, Terraform, GCP, AWS (Lambda, DynamoDB)
CI/CD and testing: CircleCI, Datadog, TDD, Cypress, Cucumber **AI tools:** Claude Code, Cursor